

LOOMBOUND

VOLUME 01:
THE FIRST ASCENT

織機の束縛



"PATCHWORK"
POGO



BIX
TUNER
U

JUNO
THE HOOK
J

MANTA
- CREW -

MANTA

THE MANTA INTERIOR

A WORKSHOP.
A CLIMBER'S DEN.
A CREW.
A PROBLEM.
LET'S GET
TO WORK.

IF WE
RE-SPOOL THE
TENSION CABLE
THROUGH A REDIRECT
RATCHET ARRAY...

...WE CAN
MULTIPLY OUR
PULL BY
THREE.

THREE
TIMES THE
PULL, HALF
THE LINE
FATIGUE.

POGO!
GET THOSE
COMPONENTS
HERE.

I'LL
CLEAR SPACE.
TOOLS
HERE.

HSSSSS



I JUST
HOPE THE
CALCULATIONS
ARE RIGHT...

BIX
FOURTEEN. THINKER.
ANXIOUS. BRILLIANT.



IT'S
WHY WE
BRING YOU
ALONG.

RENN
SIXTEEN. RIGGER.
FAST. RELIABLE.



EFFICIENCY
STARTS WITH
ORDER.

SLOANE
SIXTEEN. DISCIPLINE.
SHARP. UNBENDING.



COMING!
COMING!
SORRY!
CAREFUL!
HOT!
HEAVY!
FRAGILE!
OW!

"PATCHWORK" POGO
FIFTEEN. MECHANIC.
CHAOS. GENIUS.



UP HIGH.
KEEPIN' US
TOGETHER.
LITERALLY.

JUNO "THE HOOK"
FORTY-SOMETHING.
LEADER. ANCHOR.



THE MAIN
RISK IS SHEAR
AT THE RATCHET
JUNCTION.

IF THAT
FAILS—

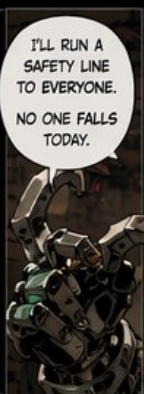


—THEN WE
INSTALL A SECONDARY
FAIL-SAFE LOOP.

I'LL MARK THE
ANCHOR POINTS.



AND I CAN
FAB THE
SHEAR DAMPERS
OUTTA THESE!



I'LL RUN A
SAFETY LINE
TO EVERYONE.
NO ONE FALLS
TODAY.



THEN LET'S
MAKE IT
BEAUTIFUL.

LET'S MAKE
IT WORK.




FOR THE MANTA.
FOR THE CLIMB.
FOR EACH OTHER.

LET'S GO.

**NEXT:
THE CLIMB.**

THREADS OF POSSIBILITY

CHAPTER 7: TUNING THE IMPOSSIBLE

BIX
AGE: 14
ROLE: THEORIST
SPECIALTY: WEFT-HARMONICS
WEAKNESS: OVERTHINKS EVERYTHING

If the harmonic weave is right... this fragment should resonate at 3.7 cycles...

Yeah yeah—show me the spark, Bix!

"PATCHWORK" POGO
AGE: 15
ROLE: MECHANIC
SPECIALTY: MAKESHIFT SOLUTIONS
WEAKNESS: IMPATIENT TO THE POINT OF HAZARDOUS



INSTALLING
PHYSICAL DELIVERY
MECHANISM.

AKA:
THE PLAN.

MANTA 02

JUNO "THE HOOK"
CLIMBER. MECHANIC.
HULL SPECIALIST.
LEFT ARM: SALVAGED
DREADNOUGHT GRADE.

RENN
JUNIOR CLIMBER.
TENSION TECH.
EXCEPTIONAL PAIN
TOLERANCE.

BRACKET
NEEDS TO SIT
FLUSH. NO
GIVE.

COPY.
TENSION'S
GOOD.

YOU
WANNA BET
ON THAT,
OLD LADY?

KSSSHHHH

KLANG

NOT A BET.
A PLAN.
NOW KEEP
THAT LINE
STEADY.

ALWAYS.
LET'S MAKE
HISTORY.

**PHASE ONE:
SECURED.**

SLOANE & "PATCHWORK" POGO

MAINTENANCE DECK · ANCHORITE VANGUARD
THIRD WATCH

CROSS-REFERENCING
BIX'S READINGS WITH
FLEET SUPPLY DATA.

PROJECTING
WINDOWS. TIGHT,
BUT VIABLE.

SUPPLY RELAY · FLEET FEED

- REACTOR PELLETS 87%
- MANTLE COOLANT 61%
- SPARE MAG CLAMPS 23%
- RATIONS (SYNTHLOAF) 42%
- MED SUPPLIES 68%
- EVA SEALS 31%

EST. RESUPPLY WINDOW:

2D 17h - 2D 23h



POGO.

THAT FLOW
ROUTE IS BACKWARD.

YOU'RE FEEDING
COOLANT INTO THE
VENT LINE.

FLIP THE VALVE.
THEN BLEED THE
RESIDUAL PRESSURE
BEFORE YOU RESEAL
THE CASING.

RIGHT-
RIGHT!

FLOW
ROUTE
INVERTED!

GOT IT!

1. FLIP
VALVE.

KLACK!

2. BLEED
PRESSURE.

HSSSSS...

3. RESEAL
CASING.

CHNK!

DONE.

PRESSURE
NOMINAL!

GOOD.

LOG THE CHANGE.
UPDATE THE TIMELINE.

AND PATCH YOUR
APRON. YOU'RE LEAKING
ON MY FLOOR AGAIN.

YES, MA'AM!

PATCH IT
AFTER THIS
CYCLE! ♥

DISCIPLINE KEEPS US ALIVE.
PRECISION KEEPS US WINNING.



DAY 47 OF OUR ESCAPE
THE OLD TENSION WORKS

IF WE CUT
THE LINE, THE
LOAD WHIPS.

IF WE FIGHT
THE LINE, THE
ANCHORS BREAK.

BUT IF WE
GIVE IT SLACK—
CONTROLLED SLACK—

THE SYSTEM
CAN MOVE
WITHOUT
BREAKING.

THE SLACK LOOP

INPUT
(TAUT)

OUTPUT
(CONTROLLED)



SLACK
BUFFER

ABSORB / REDIRECT / RECONVERGE

SO WE
DON'T WIN
AGAINST IT.

WE FLOW
WITH IT.

LOGIC
HOLDS.

THE SLACK
ABSORBS
SHOCK.

REDIRECTS
STRESS.

THEN WE
RECONVERGE
AT A NEW
VECTOR.

LIKE THIS.

A
VARIABLE
BUFFER.

TENSION
WE CAN
SPEND.

ELEGANT.

AND
PRACTICAL.

...I
APPROVE.

WE'LL CREATE OUR
OWN SLACK LOOP
IN THE SUPPORT
TENSION-KNOT.

RENNPOOL
WILL FEED THE
BUFFER.

I'LL CALCULATE
THE RELEASE
INTERVALS.

I'LL IDENTIFY THE
ANCHOR POINTS
WE CAN REROUTE.

ONCE THE LOOP
IS SET, WE SHIFT
THE LOAD AND
TRANSFER.

CLEAN. QUIET.
NO COLLAPSE.

NO HEROICS.

I-I CAN
BUILD THE
BUFFER
SPOOL.

I JUST NEED
RATINGS ON THE
RETURN STRESS
THRESHOLD
AND—

HEH.

THAT'S WHY
WE'RE A
CREW.

YOU DRAW
THE PLAN.

WE'LL MAKE IT
REAL.

DISCIPLINE.

INGENUITY.

ADAPTATION.

THREE
PILLARS.

ONE
ESCAPE.

SLACK ISN'T
WEAKNESS.

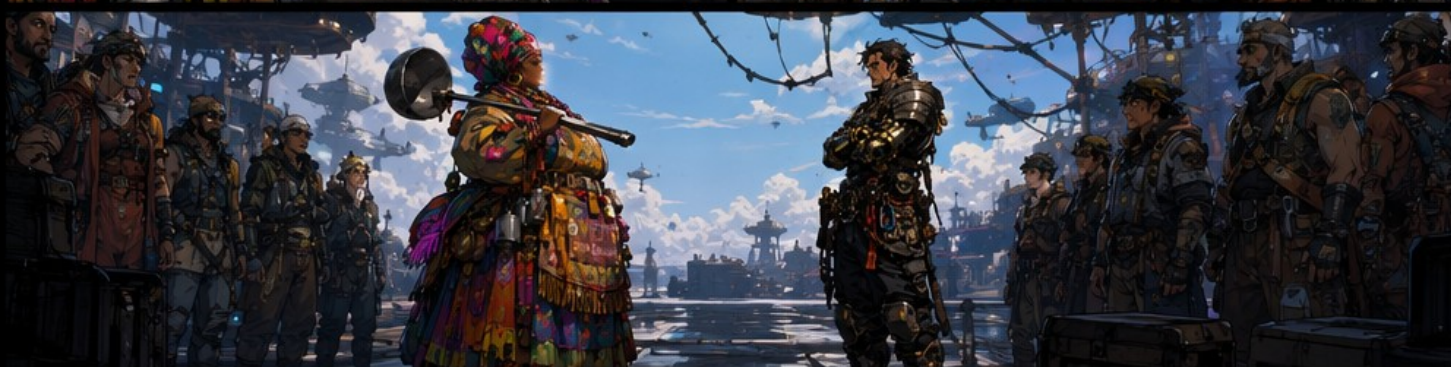
IT'S
LEVERAGE.

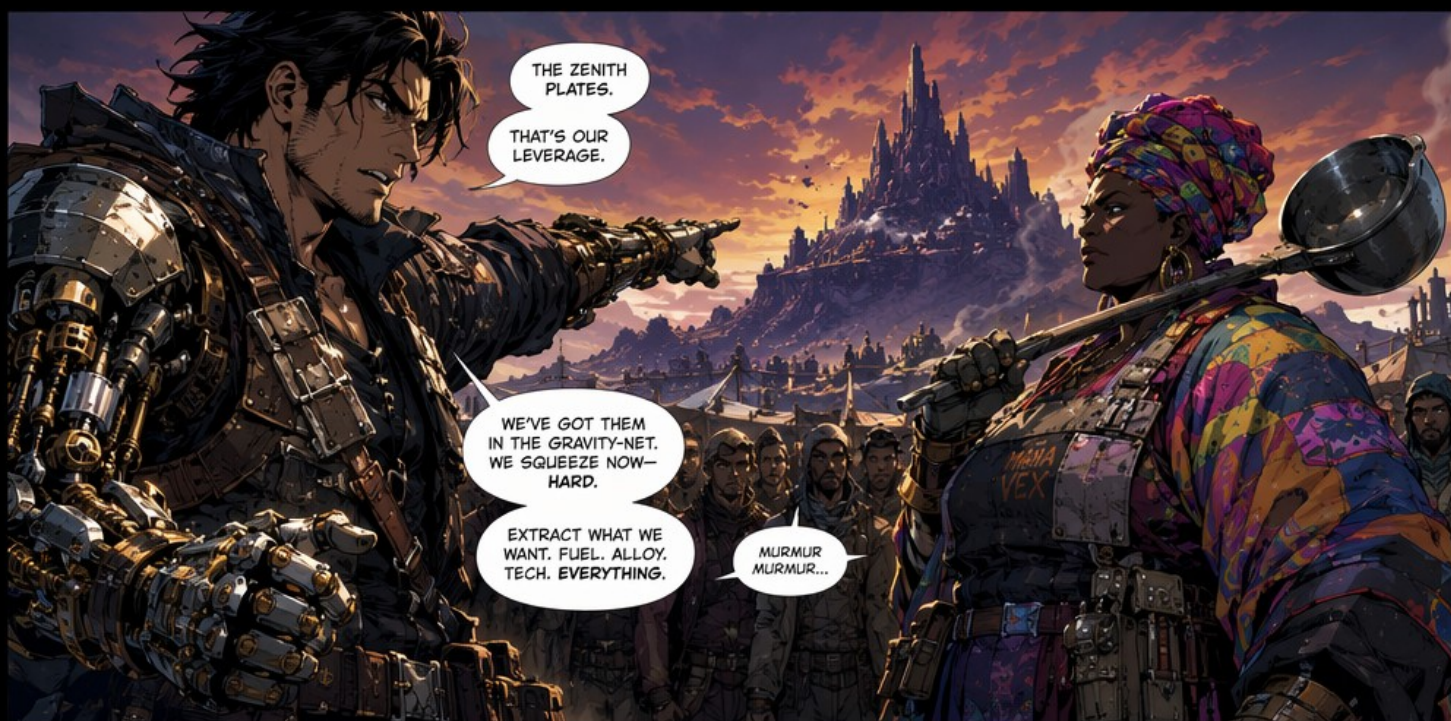
TOMORROW,
WE MOVE.



SHE RUNS
THIS FLEET.
ON SOUP,
SALVAGE,
AND FEAR.

I RUN IT
ON TENSION,
TIMING,
AND THE
EDGE.





THE ZENITH
PLATES.
THAT'S OUR
LEVERAGE.

WE'VE GOT THEM
IN THE GRAVITY-NET.
WE SQUEEZE NOW-
HARD.

EXTRACT WHAT WE
WANT. FUEL. ALLOY.
TECH. EVERYTHING.

MURMUR
MURMUR...



THE VANGUARD'S
STILL REELING.

THEY WON'T
RISK A FULL
RESPONSE YET.

WE HIT THEM
WHERE IT HURTS-
THEIR REFINERIES,
THEIR SHIPYARDS,
THEIR PRIDE.

MAKE THEM
PAY TO BREATHE.



I WANT THE NETS
TIGHTENED. ALL OF
THEM.

NO SLACK.

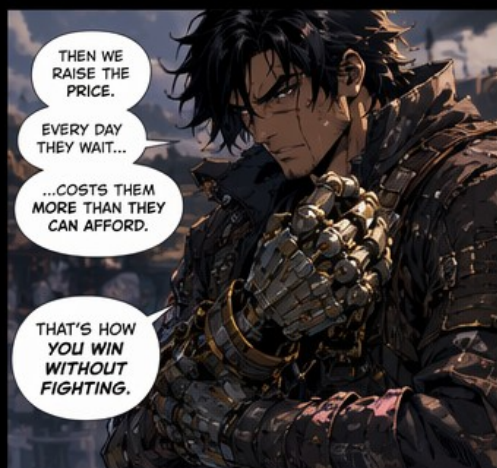
THIS ISN'T
A SHOW OF
STRENGTH.

IT'S BUSINESS.



...AND WHEN
THEY COME
KNOCKING?

...



THEN WE
RAISE THE
PRICE.

EVERY DAY
THEY WAIT...

...COSTS THEM
MORE THAN THEY
CAN AFFORD.

THAT'S HOW
YOU WIN
WITHOUT
FIGHTING.



MURMUR...

IS IT WISE?

THE VANGUARD
WON'T FORGET.

MURMUR...

BUT THE NET...
IT HOLDS.



HMM.

MAMA
VEX DOESN'T
FORGET
EITHER.



MAMA VEX

Matron of the Tangle's
Free Market Convoy

Feeder. Fixer. Founder.
Fierce.

WE AIN'T
BUILDIN' THE FUTURE
ON CRUELTY.

KAELEN "KAEL" VOSS

Field Commander, Vanguard Climb Fleet

Tactical Genius. Relentless.
Scars earned. Trust hard-won.
Left hand replaced. Patience thin.

WE BUILD
WHAT KEEPS US
ALIVE.

KCHK

VOSS TIGHTENS
THE CALIBRATION
RATCHET.

CRUELTY
MIGHT MAKE YOU
FEAR.

BUT RESPECT?
LOYALTY? A FUTURE?
THOSE YOU EARN.

NOT BEG.
NOT BREAK OUTTA
FOLKS.

NO EMPTY
BOWLS

YOU WANT A FLEET
THAT LASTS? THEN
YOU LEAD SOMETHIN'
WORTH FOLLOWIN'.

NOT SOMETHIN'
FOLKS FEAR
TO DEFY.

CLENCH

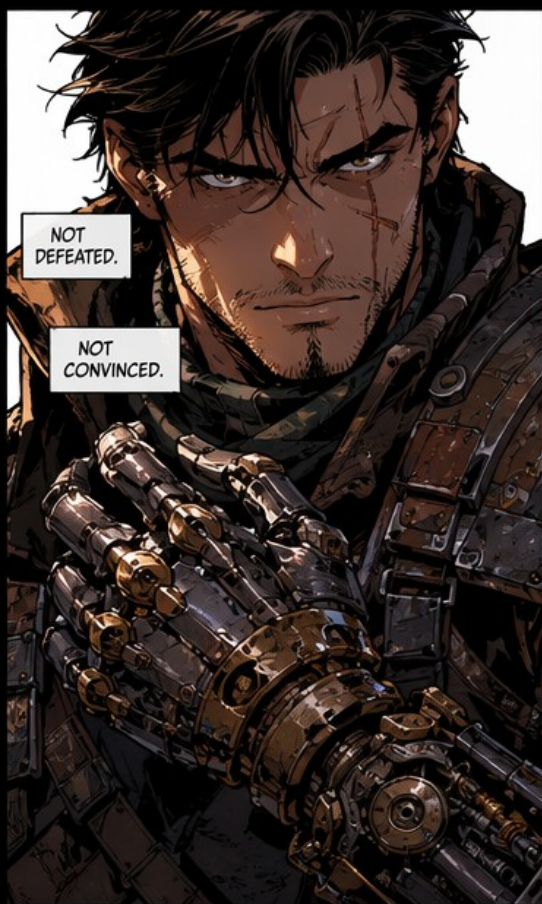
THUNK

...

MM...

SHE RIGHT.

HMM.



NOT
DEFEATED.

NOT
CONVINCED.



JUST...
UNFINISHED.

MATRON "MAMA" VEX
TANGLE KITCHENS
FEEDER OF FLEETS



LET HIM COOL.

HE ALWAYS
COMES BACK.



AYE. LIKE
TIDE IRONS.

NOW, GET BACK
TO WORK.

THE OTTERHAUL
WON'T GREASE
ITSELF.



KAELEN "KAEL" VOSS
VANGUARD FIELD COMMANDER
TANGLE LINEHOLD



THE TANGLE
DOESN'T NEED
VICTORIES.
IT NEEDS
PEOPLE WHO
DON'T QUIT
EASILY.



LORD-WARDEN
VALERIUS
ANCHORITE VANGUARD

DREADNOUGHT: PILLAR OF RESOLVE
BRIDGE



THE SPINDLE'S
TENSION IS
INCREASING.



ADJUST OUR
VECTOR.

INTERCEPT ON
THE WESTWARD
THREAD.



COURSE
CORRECTION.
SEVEN POINT
TWO DEGREES.



MAINTAIN
DISCIPLINE.
MAINTAIN
PURPOSE.

FAR BENEATH
THE SUNLESS SEAS,
WHERE PRESSURE
CRUSHES AND
LIGHT DIES—

—THE UNDERTOW
DRAWS ITS BREATH.

THE HADAL PASSAGE
DEPTH: 10,000 FATHOMS

MOTHER BATHYAL

SOVEREIGN OF THE UNDERTOW.

SHE DOES NOT WALK.
SHE DRIFTS.

HER SUIT CIRCULATES
A LIQUEFIED ATMOSPHERE
OF GOLDEN HAZE.

SHE NEEDS NO AIR.
SHE IS THE DEEP.

SHE LEADS.
NOT WITH COMMAND,
BUT WITH INEVITABILITY.

THE CURRENT PARTS.
THE STONE REMEMBERS.
THE UNDERTOW FOLLOWS.

HER VEIL HIDES
WHAT SHOULD NOT
BE SEEN.

HER PRESENCE
RENDERS WHAT
CANNOT BE
IGNORED.

THE PASSAGE
NARROWS.

THE DARK
THICKENS.

YET SHE
DOES NOT
HURRY.

SHE NEVER
HAS TO.

TO FOLLOW
MOTHER BATHYAL
IS TO ACCEPT
A TRUTH
BENEATH ALL
OTHERS—

—THAT THE DEEP
HAS A WILL.

THE MANTA CENTRAL WORKBENCH

WE DON'T
GET MANY
NIGHTS LIKE
THIS.

ALL HANDS.
ONE PLAN.
ONE SHOT.

THEN WE
CLIMB.

ABOVE
IS WHERE
WE LIVE



....AND THE
COUNTER-WEIGHT
PULLEY ARRAY
HERE...

TAP

...SHOULD
COMPENSATE
FOR DRIFT ON
THE ASCENT.

HEH.
LOOKS LIKE
IT'LL HOLD.

IF YOUR
MATH IS
CORRECT.

WHICH IT
USUALLY
ISN'T.

DON'T WORRY,
SLOANE!
I GREASED
EVERYTHING!

NOTHING'S
GONNA BREAK
(PROBABLY)!

MM.
THAT'S WHY
I KEEP YOU
AROUND.

YOU LOT
GET IT
DONE.

THE PLAN

- ☒ REACH GONDOLA
- ☒ CUT THE LOCKLINES
- ☒ RIDE THE CURRENT
- ☒ HOOK THE BEAST
- ☒ CLIMB
- ☒ DON'T DIE

LET'S GO.



BIX
CHIEF TINKER
AGE: 14



RENN
ROPE JOCKEY
AGE: 16



SLOANE
NAVIGATOR
AGE: 16



PATCHWORK
"POGO"
CHIEF MECHANIC
AGE: 15



JUNO
"THE HOOK"
BOSUN
AGE: 45



THE MANTA!
KITE REPORTING
IN!

BIG NEWS
FROM THE
FLEET!



KITE?
WHAT'S GOT YOU
BREATHLESS?



MESSAGE
FROM UP TOP!
STRAIGHT FROM
CAPTAIN DUNE!



SUPPLY LINES
ARE SECURE!
HOLDING STRONG!

NO PIRATE
INTERCEPTS!
ALL CLEAR!

THAT'S... THAT'S
A RELIEF.
GOOD WORK,
KITE.



HA! THE
FLEET'S REALLY
HOLDING, HUH?
HELL YEAH!



YOU GOT THAT
ALL THE WAY
DOWN HERE?
YOU'RE AMAZING,
KIDDO.

THANKS,
MIRA!



I TOLD YOU
I'D DELIVER IT
MYSELF!

MISSION
COMPLETE!



THAT'S OUR
KITE.
FEARLESS AS
ALWAYS.



ALRIGHT, CREW!
LET'S GET BACK
TO WORK!
THE MANTA'S
COUNTING ON US!

THE DRIFT-FLEET
TURNS AS ONE.

NO LONGER SCATTERED.
NO LONGER DRIFTING.



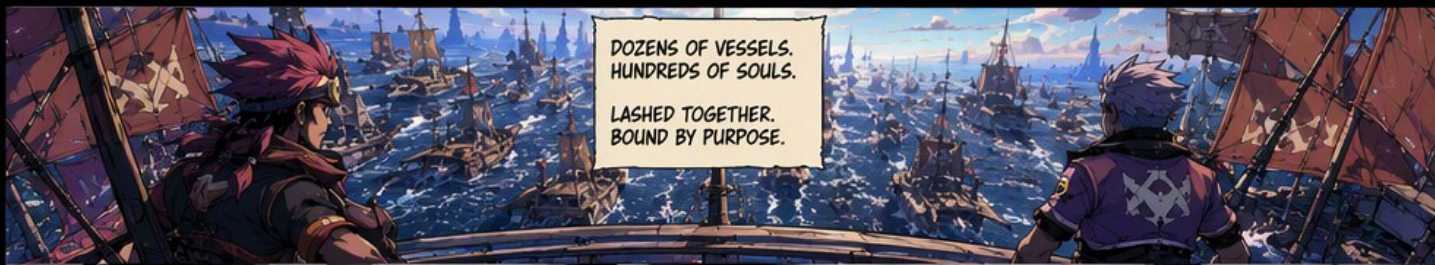
THE MANTA.
STEADY AS THE TIDE.



THE SWING-CLIPPER.
FIERCE AS THE WIND.



DOZENS OF VESSELS.
HUNDREDS OF SOULS.
LASHED TOGETHER.
BOUND BY PURPOSE.



BANNERS OF RUST
AND REBELLION...
A HUNDRED STORIES
FLYING AS ONE.



ONE DESTINATION.
ONE FUTURE.



THE DRIFT-FLEET
DOES NOT HESITATE.
THE DRIFT-FLEET
DOES NOT TURN BACK.



WE MOVE...
WITH SLOW, DELIBERATE PURPOSE.
TOWARD TOMORROW.



THE LOOM

END.

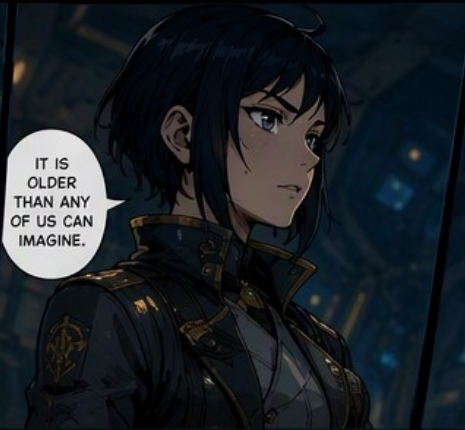


THE LOOM.

ANCIENT TUNING-FORK
OF THE FIRST SING.

BUILT TO HARMONIZE
WORLDS.

NOW IT SLEEPS.



THE LOOM AWAKENS.
THE SONG BEGINS.

TO BE CONTINUED...

THE
SPINDLE
CYCLE

— BOOK I —